

Virus Task: Quick Start

Prerequisite

Make sure **R** and **RStudio** are installed on the computer before starting.

First-time setup

1. Open `pygame_virus_aid_onset.Rproj` in RStudio. This ensures that R is working from the correct project folder.
2. If the R package **reticulate** is not already installed, run this once in the R console:

```
install.packages("reticulate")
```

3. Open `0-setup_pygame.R` and run the entire script (click **Source** in RStudio). The script creates the **r-pygame** Python environment and installs Pygame. An internet connection is required, and the first setup may take a few minutes.
4. Wait until the script finishes and displays the Python configuration. You only need to repeat this setup if the environment is removed or an installation error occurs.

Run the experiment

1. Open `1-run_virus_task.R` and run the entire script by clicking **Source**.
2. The pre-task instructions will open first. Follow the on-screen prompts to complete them.
3. The task will then open full-screen and ask for a numeric participant number. Enter the assigned number carefully; it determines the participant's block order and response-key mapping.
4. Continue through the practice block and all three main blocks. Use the D and J keys as shown in the on-screen instructions.
5. At the final **EXPERIMENT COMPLETE** screen, press **Esc** to close the task.

Results are saved automatically as CSV files in the project's `output/` folder. Do not move or rename these files during a session.

If something goes wrong

- If R reports that it cannot find `0-helpers.R` or the `python/` files, reopen `pygame_virus_aid_onset.Rproj` and try again.
- For an emergency exit at any point, press **Option + Q** on macOS or **Alt + Q** on Windows/Linux. Data from an interrupted block may be incomplete, so tell the experiment supervisor.